

The Speed vs. Squarespace Cheat Sheet

Why your wellness website's load time is costing you clients (and what to do about it)

By Naoman Saeed · Bespoke Web Engineer

I created this guide after watching too many talented wellness professionals struggle with slow, expensive websites that don't reflect the quality of their work. You spend years perfecting your craft—your yoga sequences, your skincare formulations, your retreat experiences. But when potential clients visit your website and it takes 6 seconds to load, they're gone before they ever see what you offer. This cheat sheet breaks down exactly what's happening, what it's costing you, and what a better path looks like.

The 3-Second Rule

Research shows that 53% of mobile visitors abandon a website that takes longer than 3 seconds to load. For wellness professionals serving affluent clients, this isn't just about numbers—it's about losing people who are actively searching for exactly what you offer.

Your ideal clients have options. When your site feels sluggish compared to the polished experiences they're used to, they don't wait around. They click back and find someone else whose website loads instantly.

Side-by-Side Comparison

What Matters	Squarespace / Wix	Hand-Coded Site
Load Time	4-8 seconds	0.5-1.5 seconds
Monthly Platform Fees	\$23-\$65/month	\$0/month
Design Uniqueness	Limited to templates	Unlimited custom design
Security	Plugin vulnerabilities	Built with security in mind
Mobile Performance	Often slow on phones	Lightning-fast everywhere
SEO Performance	Generic optimization	Fully optimized structure
Ownership	You rent the platform	You own everything
Long-Term Cost	Pays forever	One-time investment

The Real Cost Over 3 Years

Let's look at what you actually spend when you choose a website builder versus a hand-coded solution.

The Squarespace Path

Platform subscription: \$33/month × 36 months

Premium plugins: \$20/month × 36 months

Template upgrades: \$100-300 one-time

Developer help when things break: \$200-500/year

Total: ~\$2,500+

The Hand-Coded Path

One-time custom build: \$1,500-2,500

Hosting: \$0/month (Netlify free tier)

Optional updates: \$99/month retainer

Security updates: Included forever

Total: \$1,500-2,500

The surprising truth: A hand-coded website often costs *less* over three years than renting a template builder—and you get dramatically better performance, complete ownership, and a design that actually reflects your brand.

What This Means for Your Business

Beyond the financial logic, here's what faster, hand-coded websites actually do for your practice:

- **Client retention:** Visitors stay engaged when your site loads instantly. They actually see your offerings, read your philosophy, and book that discovery call.

- **Google ranking:** Page speed is a direct ranking factor. Faster sites appear higher in search results, bringing you more organic traffic.
- **Brand perception:** A lightning-fast, beautifully crafted website signals attention to detail. It tells potential clients you care about quality in every aspect of your work.
- **Peace of mind:** No more worrying about plugin updates breaking your site, security vulnerabilities, or surprise price increases from your platform.

The bottom line: Squarespace is like renting a generic storefront in a crowded mall. Hand-coded is like owning a bespoke boutique that reflects your brand's unique value—and loads 5-10× faster.

Your Next Step

If you're ready to see how your current site performs, here's what I recommend:

- ✓ Run your website through [Google's PageSpeed Insights](#) (it's free)
- ✓ Note your current load time and performance score
- ✓ If your score is below 80 or load time is over 3 seconds, it might be time for a conversation
- ✓ Visit my services page to learn more about the hand-coded approach

[Explore the Hand-Coded Approach →](#)

About the Author

Naoman Saeed is a bespoke web engineer who hand-codes lightning-fast, accessible websites for wellness professionals and artisan makers. He believes the web should be as carefully crafted as the products and services it represents.

Naoman documents his technical journey and shares insights at trogdyne.com.

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Crafting hand-coded websites for wellness professionals and artisan makers